Administrative Changes to AFSCI61-101, *Technology Modernization*

OPR: AFSC/ENS

References in the RELEASABILITY statement to “publicationa” are hereby changed to “publication.”

References throughout to “ServiceNow” are hereby changed to “host”.

27 APRIL 2026

BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER
AIR FORCE SUSTAINMENT CENTER

AIR FORCE SUSTAINMENT CENTER
INSTRUCTION 61-101

26 MARCH 2026

Scientific Research and Development

TECHNOLOGY MODERNIZATION

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

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(Mr. Clay T. Jordan)

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This instruction implements Department of the Air Force Policy Directive (DAFPD) 61-1, *Management of the Science and Technology Enterprise,* and supports the Department of the Air Force's broader goals of building a more lethal, resilient, and rapidly innovating force through effective science and technology management. Aligned with the Air Force's approach to Science and Technology (S&T) management, this AFSCI promotes the planning, governance, and execution of S&T activities within the Air Force Sustainment Center (AFSC), as described in Air Force Instruction (AFI) 61-101, *Management of Science & Technology*. This Air Force Sustainment Center Instruction (AFSCI) also reinforces the importance of integrated life cycle systems engineering and technical management, in accordance with Air Force Materiel Command Instruction (AFMCI) 63-1201, *Integrated Life Cycle Systems Engineering and Technical Management.* This instruction standardizes, verifies, and maintains required mission accomplishments; and it adheres to the AFSC corporate review process, which is outlined and facilitated by AFSCI 90-601, *AFSC Corporate Structure.* This AFSCI directs the use of MAster Enterprise Strategy for Technology and Resource Optimization (MAESTRO) for all Capital Investment Program (CIP) and externally funded AFSC technology modernization efforts, ensuring an enterprise approach to addressing capability gaps through technology solutions. All AFSC military and civilian personnel involved in managing, overseeing the application of, or implementing solutions through technology modernization are subject to this instruction, with the exception of the Air Force Reserve and Air National Guard personnel. This instruction complies with AFI 33-322 for records management and the Air Force Records Information Management System for disposal. Supplements directly related to this instruction require AFSC/EN (Engineering Directorate) coordination prior to approval. This instruction document complements

AFSCI 20-101, *Depot Processes and Programs Management*, for the Capital Investment Program (CIP) through the project management capabilities and alignment to enterprise strategic goals. Direct any changes or questions through your chain of command via DAF Form 847 to AFSC/EN, 3001 Staff Dr., STE 2AF69A, Tinker AFB OK 73145.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This is a complete rewrite of AFSCI 61-101, 17 March 2020, and needs to be reviewed in its entirety. This instruction's major update reflects a shift from directing a technology insertion process to presenting a standardized modernization approach for organizations to follow, while standardizing MAESTRO as the authoritative toolset to track efforts. This standardization facilitates the development and execution of a technology modernization roadmap that drives AFSC towards its strategic goals, while enabling strategic oversight at the AFSC and AFSC/EN levels to ensure alignment of subordinate organizational strategies with the AFSC Technology Modernization Strategy.

Chapter 1

GENERAL INFORMATION

1.1. Overview. This instruction establishes and standardizes the Air Force Sustainment Center (AFSC) technology modernization framework, known as the Sustainment Enterprise Approach for Modernization (SEAM). The SEAM is the standardized AFSC technology modernization framework to guide the identification, development, and execution of efforts to fill AFSC capability gaps, as outlined in section three of this instruction. Technology modernization projects across the AFSC, including the Capital Investment Program (CIP) and external program-specific funding, are funded through diverse streams, which each have their own unique and often statutorily or procedurally mandated processes for justification, approval, and reporting. While the existing processes remain in place, this instruction implements MAESTRO as the AFSC authoritative source of truth for technology modernization projects, granting enterprise-level visibility, strategic alignment, cross-organizational collaboration, portfolio analysis, and project management capability. MAESTRO's scope will, at a minimum, encompass all CIP and externally funded technology modernization projects; however, AFSC/EN encourages all technology modernization efforts to be captured in MAESTRO to provide maximum enterprise visibility. MAESTRO enables strategic oversight at the AFSC and AFSC/EN levels, ensuring alignment of organizational efforts with the AFSC Technology Modernization Strategy. This standardization facilitates the development and execution of a technology modernization roadmap that drives AFSC towards its strategic goals.

Chapter 2

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1. Overview. AFSC technology modernization requires a coordinated effort, merging strategic direction and data-driven insights to inform effective decision making. MAESTRO will be used as the AFSC authoritative source of truth for demonstrating the alignment of technology modernization efforts to organizational and enterprise strategic goals. The roles assigned to personnel involved are as follows:

2.1.1. **Commander, Air Force Sustainment Center (AFSC/CC) will:**

2.1.1.1. Publish and widely disseminate updates to the AFSC Strategic Plan and AFSC Technology Modernization Strategy that communicates the Center's priorities, objectives, and strategic direction to all stakeholders.

2.1.2. Advocate for the AFSC strategic goals, technology modernization, and priorities throughout the Air Force Materiel Command (AFMC) enterprise and to Air Force senior leadership, as required.

2.2. Engineering Director, Air Force Sustainment Center (AFSC/EN) will:

2.2.1. Collaborate with stakeholders across AFSC to:

2.2.1.1. Facilitate innovative approaches and best practices, to foster a culture of continuous improvement.

2.2.1.2. Support the adoption of technologies that align with AFSC’s strategic goals.

2.2.2. Develop and maintain the AFSC Technology Modernization Strategy and the Sustainment Enterprise Approach for Modernization (SEAM) to achieve effective insertion of modern technologies aligned to AFSC goals.

2.2.2.1. Establish enterprise Modernization Areas and time-phased goals to achieve strategic objectives.

2.2.3. Support the AFSC Corporate Structure with decision support analysis and recommendations.

2.2.3.1. Review and approve enterprise strategic modernization roadmaps.

2.2.4. Co-chair the Futures Panel, per AFSCI 90-601, *AFSC Corporate Structure*, to provide strategic foresight and make decisions on emerging technologies, future threats, and evolving capability gaps.

2.3. Technical Director, Air Force Sustainment Center (AFSC/EN) will:

2.3.1. Facilitate the development, integration, and oversight of strategic modernization roadmaps within MAESTRO, ensuring alignment to the Modernization Areas (MAs) as defined by AFSC Technology Modernization Strategy.

2.3.1.1. Collaborate with process owners to develop and maintain the standardized prioritization processes, as retained in MAESTRO. For CIP projects, prioritization will be in alignment with the AFSCI 20-101.

2.3.1.2. Ensure the prioritized projects align with enterprise strategy.

2.3.2. Ensure the strategic modernization roadmaps:

2.3.2.1. Provide data necessary to drive decisions and actions.

2.3.2.2. Correlate incremental planned steps and milestones to the time-phased Modernization Area goals of the AFSC Technology Modernization Strategy.

2.3.2.3. Demonstrate modernization effort alignment with AFSC strategic priorities defined in the most recent AFSC Strategic Plan.

2.3.3. Accelerate AFSC-wide modernization by championing best practices and the proliferation of project solutions.

2.3.4. Provide modernization area and associated portfolios updates to Futures Panel on annual basis.

2.3.5. Provide MAESTRO requirements to configuration control board (CCB), supporting the creation of detailed modernization plans, project tracking, cross-organizational collaboration, and corporate decision-making.

2.4. AFSC/EN Staff will:

2.4.1. Support the AFSC/EN technical director in adapting and deploying proven project solutions and best practices across AFSC:

2.4.1.1. Document and maintain best practices and user guides in the MAESTRO knowledge articles.

2.4.1.2. Promote tailored MAESTRO support and training to users for effective utilization and request their ongoing feedback to enhance system functionality.

2.4.1.3. Use MAESTRO feedback to generate standardized requirements to bring to the configuration control board for approval and liaise with A6 to ensure the toolset meets requirements.

2.4.2. Facilitate collaboration and communication across AFSC to reduce duplicative efforts, accelerate analysis & planning, identify funding opportunities, share successes, and enable MAESTRO as the AFSC authoritative source of truth for effort alignment to strategic goals.

2.4.2.1. Stand up and lead various Integrated Product Teams (IPTs) or Working Groups (WGs) as needed to provide structure for collaboration. IPTs and WGs will be composed of relevant personnel from across the AFSC and external organizations (e.g. AFLCMC, AFNWC, NAVAIR, AMCOM, etc.)

2.4.3. Manage assigned portfolio(s) within MAESTRO.

2.4.4. Collaborate with MAESTRO users to develop a data standard for all prioritized programs and update the standard as required.

2.4.4.1. Collaborate with MAESTRO users to build process-specific templates that increase in ease of use.

2.4.5. Ensure prioritized projects contain sufficient data to enable review of strategic alignment.

2.5. AFSC Directorates, Air Logistics Complexes (ALC's), Air Base Wings (ABW's), and 448 Supply Chain Management Wing (448 SCMW) will:

2.5.1. Adopt the SEAM framework for technology modernization as described in section three of this instruction.

2.5.2. Document all identified capability gaps directly within MAESTRO, maintaining accurate and sufficient modernization project data within the toolset to enable review of strategic alignment.

2.5.3. Use MAESTRO to manage the various efforts that address capability gaps, leveraging MAESTRO to track progress, identify trends, and support data-driven decisions.

2.5.3.1. Track and report on project deadlines, milestones, and prioritization to ensure success of the programs and initiatives therein, as well as the success of the enterprise level goals to which those projects are aligned.

2.5.4. Advocate for technology modernization by presenting data-driven justifications that highlight the impact on mission readiness and strategic alignment.

2.5.5. Assign personnel to fulfill the various roles within MAESTRO as necessary to document and track efforts in the system. Refer to MAESTRO knowledge articles for the most up-to-date information on system roles and data requirements.

2.6. AFSC/A6 (Cyberspace and Information Technology (IT) Directorate) will:

2.6.1. Ensure MAESTRO supports AFSC modernization objectives and aligns with relevant policies, by maintaining a governance structure to guide future development, as well as data and system integrations. AFSC/A6 is responsible for developing a strategy to integrate MAESTRO with the current and future data systems for AFSC's modernization projects to create a unified user experience and reduce duplicate data entries.

2.6.2. Maintain reliable system operation through ongoing administration, proactive maintenance, and implementing robust disaster recovery protocols.

2.6.3. Safeguard data integrity by establishing and enforcing comprehensive data governance policies and procedures. These procedures must ensure data availability, security, and integrity, with a key objective of enabling seamless, bi-directional integration with other authoritative AFSC systems.

2.6.4. Uphold MAESTRO's security and compliance posture through regular assessments, proactive incident management, and adherence to all applicable regulatory requirements.

2.6.5. Provide effective technical system support to MAESTRO users through a help desk for accounts, connectivity, and system errors.

2.6.6. Drive system performance and enhancements through regular performance monitoring and prioritized implementation of improvements based on strategic priorities, user needs, and user feedback.

2.6.7. Oversee vendor relationships (if applicable) by managing contracts, monitoring adherence to software licensing agreements and coordinating necessary resources & services. Funding allocation will be approved annually via the Futures Panel.

2.6.8. Establish and maintain a CCB to guide the integrations of MAESTRO and address user input to MAESTRO future releases.

2.7. 78th Air Base Wing Communications Directorate will:

2.7.1. Manage the MAESTRO application within a DISA approved cloud for the ServiceNow platform, which must be accredited to DoD Impact Level 4 (IL4) at a minimum. 78 ABW/SC will ensure service continuity by overseeing the platform's Service Level Agreement (SLA) and managing all ServiceNow case communications, noting that service continuity exclude all pre-scheduled vendor upgrades and maintenance.

2.7.2. Establish and govern the logical access control framework for the MAESTRO application, including the creation and maintenance of roles and their associated permissions. The objective is to provide the AFSC MAESTRO Product Owner with the capability to manage day-to-day user assignments to these pre-defined roles. 78 ABW/SC remains fully responsible for maintaining compliant single sign-on (SSO) integration and enforcing multi-factor authentication (MFA) policies.

2.7.3. Perform system administration for the MAESTRO instance by managing the platform upgrade and patch lifecycle, monitoring application performance and system integrations, overseeing the cloning process to support development activities, and managing the release and deployment of approved application enhancements into the production environment contingent upon successful User Acceptance Testing (UAT) and formal CCB approval.

2.7.4. Oversee the application's backup and recovery strategy by leveraging the native capabilities of the ServiceNow platform. 78 ABW/SC is responsible for understanding the platform's recovery objectives, validating these capabilities in coordination with the vendor, and utilizing platform tools such as Update Sets to manage application changes and enable the rapid rollback of specific configurations.

2.7.5. Provide technical guidance and troubleshooting for the MAESTRO application in partnership with the AFSC MAESTRO Product Owner and contracted partners. 78 ABW/SC is responsible for leading the technical diagnosis of issues related to the application's configuration, performance, and integrations, in close coordination with the Product Owner and relevant contractors. For faults determined to be caused by the underlying platform, 78 ABW/SC will act as the primary liaison for incident escalation to the vendor.

2.7.6. Manage the technical deployment of all platform updates and application enhancements for MAESTRO. Major platform releases shall be coordinated with AFSC/A6, while routine security patches may be deployed at the discretion of 78 ABW/SC. For internally developed enhancements, 78 ABW/SC will execute the deployment, in coordination with contracted partners as required, upon receipt of formal CCB approval secured by the Product Owner.

2.8. AFSC/A3/4 (Logistics, Operations and Civil Engineering Directorate) will:

2.8.1. Maintain the roles and responsibilities laid out within Chapter 2 of AFSCI 20-101, *Depot Processes and Programs Management*, in collaboration with AFSC.

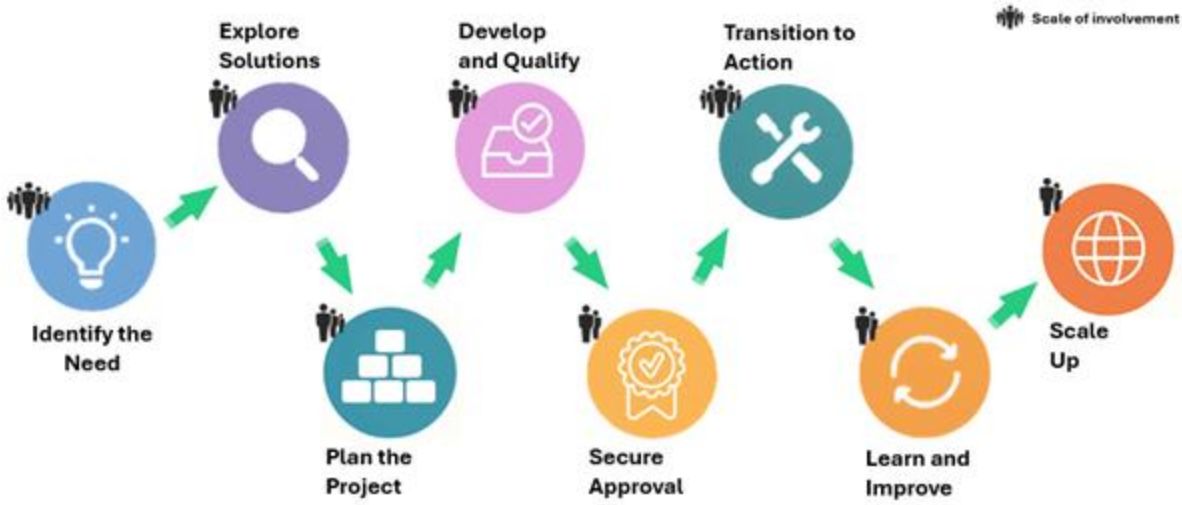
2.8.2. Collaborate with AFSC/EN to ensure strategic alignment for CIP requirements.

Chapter 3

GUIDANCE AND PROCEDURES

3.1. Overview. AFSC will use SEAM for developing and managing technology modernization projects. MAESTRO serves as both a toolset for this framework and the AFSC authoritative source of truth for project data and status. Below is an abbreviated outline of the SEAM, with further details found within the MAESTRO platform as knowledge articles.

Figure 3.1. Sustainment Enterprise Approach for Modernization (SEAM).



3.1.1. **Identify the Need:** Pinpoint a specific capability gap. Capture the various requirements that any solutions will need to meet; define the scope and the interfaces with the greater system. Identify and include stakeholders throughout.

3.2. Explore Solutions: Use MAESTRO, Integrated Product Teams (IPTs), and Working Groups (WGs) to look across AFSC to see if solution already exists. Explore industry solutions. Perform an analysis of alternatives or trade study to define the best solution(s).

3.3. Plan the Project: Create a clear plan that refines scope, budget, schedule, and required resources. Ensure alignment to the AFSC Technology Modernization Strategy.

3.4. Develop & Qualify: Further develop the technology and solution, as needed; test and evaluate the solution. This might involve prototypes, lab tests, and/or field trials; the goal is to demonstrate that stakeholder requirements are met and that the project can move onto implementation.

3.5. Secure Approval: Present the tested solution to authoritative stakeholders for approval. This may include system program offices, production leaders, and supply chain. Document any feedback, approvals, and/or rejections and adjust accordingly.

3.6. Transition to Action: Implement the capability gap solution. This encompasses the work necessary to field the solution.

3.7. Learn and Improve: Document lessons learned to improve future efforts. Feedback on the chosen solution and the SEAM framework are essential for continuous improvement.

3.8. Scale Up: AFSC/EN will drive much of the sharing of solutions across appropriate organizations of AFSC if the originating organization of the solution reports fulfillment of project metrics; some examples on how this may be accomplished include regularly held working groups and integrated product team meetings, industry meetings, technical interchange meetings, and through direct outreach to potential users.

Chapter 4

COLLABORATION ACROSS AFSC

4.1. Overview. The principles and procedures outlined in this instruction provide a framework for technology modernization, but true transformation requires a unified effort that transcends organizational boundaries. Siloed efforts and redundant systems are impediments to progress; therefore, a culture of collaboration and unbridled innovation must be fostered at every level across all organizations. By embracing a "one team, one fight" mentality, we can leverage the diverse talent and expertise within the Air Force Sustainment Center to accelerate the adoption of cutting-edge technologies, streamline processes, and directly contribute to increased readiness across the force. This collaborative spirit is the cornerstone of our ability to deliver combat readiness, modernize the industrial base, and maintain a decisive competitive advantage.

JENNIFER HAMMERSTEDT
Lieutenant General, USAF
Commander

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

DAFPD 61-1, *Management of Science and Technology*, 5 February 2021

AFI 61-101, *Management of Air Force Science & Technology*, 14 March 2013

AFMCI 63-1201, *Integrated Life Cycle Systems Engineering and Technical Management*, 2 December 2022

AFSCI 20-101, *Depot Processes and Programs Management*, 18 June 2025

AFSCI 90-601, *AFSC Corporate Structure*, 31 July 2025

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020 Incorporate Change 1, 28 July 2021

Air Force *Technology Modernization Strategy, Current Edition*

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

ABW—Air Base Wing

AFLCMC—Air Force Lifecycle Management Center

AFNWC—Air Force Nuclear Weapons Center

AFSC—Air Force Sustainment Center

AFSC/A6—Cyberspace and Information Technology Directorate, Air Force Sustainment Center

AFSC/CC—Commander, Air Force Sustainment Center

AFSC/EN—Engineering Directorate, Air Force Sustainment Center

ALC—Air Logistics Complex

AMCOM—Army Aviation and Missile Command

CIP—Capital Investment Program

IL4—Impact Level 4

IPT—Integrated Product Team

MA—Modernization Area

MAESTRO—MAster Enterprise Strategy for Technology, Resources, & Optimization

MFA—Multi-Factor Authentication

NAVAIR—Naval Air Systems Command

SEAM—Sustainment Enterprise Approach for Modernization

S&T—Science and Technology

SLA—Service Level Agreement

SCMW—Supply Chain Management Wing

SSO—Single-Sign On

UAT—User Acceptance Testing

WG—Working Group

Terms

Air Force Sustainment Center (AFSC)—The organization responsible for providing logistics, maintenance, and sustainment support to the United States Air Force.

Air Force Sustainment Center Enterprise—The entire organization of Air Force Sustainment Center.

Air Force Sustainment Center (AFSC) MAESTRO Product Owner—The designated business authority responsible for defining the application's vision and functional requirements, representing the user community, and securing all necessary stakeholder and governance approvals for enhancements

Analysis of Alternatives—Analytical comparison of the operational effectiveness, suitability, and life-cycle cost of alternatives that fill established capability gaps.

Authoritative Source of Truth—A single, trusted, and reliable system, entity, or repository that provides the most accurate and consistent data, information, or digital artifacts, ensuring all users rely on the same validated version for decision-making, reducing errors, and maintaining data governance across an organization or system

Capability Gap—The inability to meet or exceed a process or business technology requirement, resulting in an associated operational risk until closed or mitigated.

Corporate Structure—The formalized organizational framework within the AFSC that facilitates decision-making and resource allocation across the center. It includes panels, groups, boards, councils, and executive sessions.

Data-Driven Decision-Making—The practice of making decisions based on the analysis of relevant data, rather than relying solely on intuition or experience.

Engineering Authority—The designated authority responsible for validating capability gaps, overseeing the development of solutions, and ensuring technical compliance.

Integrated Life Cycle Systems Engineering and Technical Management—A comprehensive, iterative process that integrates all systems engineering and technical management activities throughout the system life cycle.

Information Technology (IT)—The use of computers, networks, and other electronic devices to store, retrieve, transmit, and manipulate data.

Knowledge Article—Documents developed collaboratively by a community of users found within MAESTRO platform that serve as user guides and capture best practices.

MAESTRO (MAster Enterprise Strategy for Technology, Resources, & Optimization)—The AFSC authoritative source of truth for all technology modernization needs and efforts, acting as the decisional database that leaders use for AFSC modernization efforts. MAESTRO supports both tactical management of individual modernization projects and strategic oversight of the overall modernization portfolio.

Modernization Area—Focus areas established for technology modernization, as defined by the AFSC Technology Modernization Strategy.

Portfolio—A collection of projects and initiatives that are managed and tracked as a cohesive unit to achieve AFSC strategic goals.

Science & Technology (S&T)—Scientific and engineering efforts that advance the state of knowledge or create new technologies.

Stakeholders—Groups or individuals with a vested interest in the operations of a system.

Technology Modernization—The process of upgrading or enhancing existing capabilities, or adding new capabilities, to meet current and future operational requirements through the application of technologies, processes, or systems.